

Question:

A baby is born after the 32nd gestational week by cesarean delivery. The mother suffered from gestational diabetes; however, she had no other pregnancy-related diseases and was otherwise healthy. The baby has a blood pressure of 100/58 mm Hg, heart rate of 104/min, and oxygen saturation of 88%. The child has tachypnea, subcostal and intercostal retractions, nasal flaring, and cyanosis. The cyanosis is responding well to initial administration of oxygen. The nasogastric tube was positioned without problems. Which of the following is the most likely diagnosis?

Answer Choices:

- A. Neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS)
- B. Tracheoesophageal fistula
- C. Pneumonia
- D. Congenital heart anomaly with right-to-left shunt

Reasoning + Answer:

<think>
To determine the most likely diagnosis , we need to analyze the symptoms and clinical findings presented . The baby has tachypnea , subcostal and intercostal retractions , nasal flaring , and cyanosis , which are indicative of respiratory distress . The cyanosis is responding to oxygen administration , suggesting that the issue is related to hypoxia rather than a cardiac cause . The presence of tachypnea and retractions suggests a problem with gas exchange or lung function . Given the baby's gestational age and the mother's gestational diabetes , we should consider conditions that are associated with prematurity or complications of prematurity . Neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS) is a common condition in premature infants , often related to surfactant deficiency , which can be exacerbated by maternal diabetes . Tracheoesophageal fistula is less likely , as the nasogastric tube was positioned without issues . Pneumonia could be a possibility , but the clinical presentation is more suggestive of a condition related to prematurity . A congenital heart anomaly with a right-to-left shunt would cause cyanosis that is not responsive to oxygen , which is not the case here . Therefore , considering the symptoms and the context , NRDS is the most likely diagnosis .</think><answer> A.
Neonatal respiratory distress syndrome (NRDS) </answer>

